



378 CE

ROMAN ARMY ROUTED

In the 370s CE, the Goths wished to settle in the Eastern Roman Empire. At first denied entry, then mistreated by Roman officials, in 378 CE they surged into the Balkans. The Eastern Roman emperor Valens intercepted them near Adrianople. Finding fewer Goths than expected, he attacked without waiting for reinforcements. The Goth cavalry – returning from a foraging expedition – swelled Goth numbers and destroyed the Romans.

◁ The Battle of Adrianople

360 CE

360 CE Julian becomes Roman emperor, beginning a pagan resurgence

378 CE

SIJAY K'AK' CONQUERS MAYA CITY OF TIKAL

The Maya of Tikal, close to Lake Petén, had expanded their territory slowly throughout the Guatemalan lowlands. However, in 378 CE a new dynasty took power after Sijay K'ak', an outsider from the city of Teotihuacan in central Mexico, overthrew the native dynasty and installed Yax Nuun Ayiin as ruler. Mexican cultural influence in Tikal grew and in this “New Order”, Tikal absorbed territory to the north and east, becoming the most powerful of the Maya city-states.

▷ Temple ruins,
Mayan city of Tikal

